

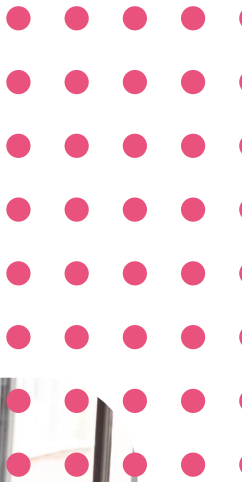
Diploma in Leadership & Management

Personal branding



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Lesson outcomes

The student will be able to understand the fundamentals of personal branding. Students will be able to understand the approaches to take when it comes to their personal brand. Student will have a clear starting point of where to get started.

Introduction

Personal branding allows you to market yourself to different companies to your colleagues and your followers. It's so important to have your own brand but establishing your person brand is not a one step process. There are several steps to take and you have to think about what you want your brand to be. This lesson is going to explore the different aspects of personal branding. "All of us need to understand the importance of branding. We are CEOs of our own companies: Me Inc. To be in business today, our most important job is to be head marketer for the brand called You." – Tom Peters in Fast Company

Key reading materials:

- <https://www.forbes.com/sites/goldiechan/2018/11/08/10-golden-rules-personal-branding/#79fef22a58a7>
- <https://www.thinkific.com/blog/personal-branding-guide/>
- <https://www.socialmediaexaminer.com/personal-branding-how-to-successfully-build-brand-rory-vaden/>

Personal branding worksheet:

Please note that this is an amazing worksheet from Emersonexhchange365 that I would like to share with you all.

Identify:

What's Your Story? The first step in the branding journey is to discover who you are, to identify what makes you unique, and to describe your true values, beliefs, passions, purposes and superpowers? What stories do you want others to know about you? How do you want them to be told? Your stories are your brand. It is important to take the time to understand your beliefs and translate them into your brand. Everyone has a brand, what varies is whether you're actively managing it or not. Many people have not taken the time to explore these questions, it can be a struggle; it requires some deep thought and inner searching.

Useful Definitions

Beliefs are concepts we hold to be true. They are basic assumptions we make about the world grown from what we see, hear, experience and think. We form opinions that we believe are true.

Values are ideas you hold to be important. They govern the way you behave, communicate and interact with others. Our values are formed from our beliefs.

Passions are your core interests; things you find a way to make time for in your life and something that causes a void when you don't have it.

Superpower is a unique talent you have. It's what you do well, better than most, what is admired by others and why you excel. Superpowers tend to create value for others when they experience it from you.

Purpose is the reason behind why you do what you do; it's your motivation, objective or intention. It is seen in your resolve or determination.

Brand is what people believe to be true about you even when you're not present.

Find Your Purpose

Step one in our workbook focuses on discovering who you are at the most core, authentic level and knowing your driving purpose in life. Purpose-oriented people tend to be happier and more successful because they are motivated by the meaning they find in or bring to their work. The right kind of work can seem almost effortless. Therefore, the first exercise we ask you to complete is to answer the question, “What’s my story?” Through accessing your experiences, we will help you define and describe the most authentic you.

Exercise: Identify Interests:

Sometimes who you are is easy to identify and articulate, it can be right on the surface. Other times you’ll need to cull through your thoughts to find the hidden gems. Identifying Page | 5 your interests is more of an obvious first step. Do you have a known passion or interest or area of expertise that you’d like to spend more time on? Are there interests for earlier in life that you remember bringing great joy? Any lifelong passions? Do you have any unique skills developed from these interests?

Exercise: Build your knowledge and interests inventory:

Identify three (3) things you admire about yourself, elements of your life you enjoy, describe your values, attitudes and beliefs and areas where you give the most effort. Think about what energizes you and what you are most passionate about. List as many as you can in a short period of time.

Tip: After the quick first pass, review your list and then dig deeper. Ask yourself why those items are important to you. This tip can be used throughout the workbook. Try to understand the why behind your actions and this will naturally lead you to a deeper understanding of yourself and guide you when choosing the areas of emphasis.

Exercise: Build your emotional inventory:

Listen to the voice in your head and ask yourself what does it feel like to interact with you? Ask how do you want people to feel when interacting with you? And, how do you want people to talk about you? Please make your list quickly – first thoughts are often the most accurate.

Exercise: Build your idea of success:

It’s important to add in a little visualizing of your definition of personal success, how your ideal day would be structured, what you are doing, where are you living, what are your priorities, who are the people you are around the most, what activities excite you, what mantras do you live by... Keep in mind the advice you’ve heard that do what you love and success will come.

Exercise: Add clarity to your purpose:

What are your superpowers? It helps to add focus to the vast number of things you’re good at or interested in – the world is full of folks with similar interests, but by focusing on your best few it will really help you stand out from the crowd. In this section add information about your results and reputation.

“I (fill in the blank) others”. What do you do better than anyone else?

Example: I (mentor and lead) others... through unknown situations.

If you received an award or public praise, what would it would be for?

Example: The award for Composure because I project calm in tough situations. Tip: Share this information with others. If you’re blocked, ask for feedback from friends and colleagues.

Please make sure to take the time to complete this worksheet. This will give you a good starting point to develop your story and your personal brand.

References

- Emersonexchange365
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